

**Medford Public Schools
Medford, Massachusetts**

Medford School Committee
Committee of the Whole
September 30, 2013

The Medford School Committee was called to order at 7:15 p.m. on Monday September 30, 2013 by chairperson John Falco in the Superintendent's Conference Room at Medford High School.

Members present: Ann Marie Cugno, Erin DiBenedetto, John Falco, George Scarpelli, Robert E. Skerry Jr. and Paulette Van der Kloot. Also Superintendent Roy E. Belson (6 present 1 absent)

All rose to salute the Flag.

Chairperson Falco stated that the purpose of the meeting was to "begin the process of evaluating the Superintendent of Schools consistent with the new procedure as mandated by the Commonwealth of Massachusetts DESE.

Chairperson Falco then called upon the Superintendent to present his self assessment and proposed goals as the initial steps in the new process.

Superintendent Belson called the committee's attention to the self assessment and goals proposal that was sent to members on Friday, September 27, 2013. He explained that the evening's agenda was designed to complete the first two steps of the five step evaluation cycle.

He began by referencing the Proposed District Priority Goals (see attached). These goals are the ones that all educators in the district will use to advance the Medford Public School in SY 2013-2014. Each District Priority Goal has an explanation of its relevance and has multiple "SMART" goals assigned to it.

The Superintendent then presented his self assessment by referencing the four required standards of the process.

Each standard was organized by having the specific rating form preface the narrative self assessment of the Superintendent. (All forms and narratives are attached to this report).

The Superintendent rated himself as proficient on all standards. He explained the definition of each rating category (see attached model system guide p.8). Proficient performance is understood to be satisfactory in terms of meeting the specific standards.

The Superintendent then discussed his two proposed “SMART” goals (see attached).

The professional practice goal was to develop his skill with online learning by producing a guide for parents, educators, and the community on important academic, emotional, social, and physical needs of our diverse student population.

The achievement goal had three parts and was consistent with District Priority Goal number three (see attached). These goals focused upon sub group achievement and improved assessment methodology.

The third section of the Superintendent’s report focused upon the multiple initiatives that must be addressed in the current year. (see attached listing)

The School Committee asked the Superintendent to add “maintenance of buildings and grounds” to the list. (This is done and part of the attachment)

The School Committee discussion centered on the challenges inherent in the Superintendent’s plan. There was concern that he was taking on too much. The Superintendent responded that they could jointly modify expectations at the mid year point if it became clear that the plan was too demanding.

Further it was important to lead the district in a challenging way to set an example for other educators.

The Committee expressed satisfaction with the self assessment and goals presentation.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto the committee voted 6-0-1 (absent) to approve the District Priority Goals; approve the two Superintendent “SMART” goals, and endorse the agenda’s of multiple initiatives as amended to include “maintenance of buildings and grounds.”

At 8:17 p.m. the committee suspended the rules to hear a presentation by citizen Judith Lonergan on a proposed Road Race and fund raising event.

At 9:05 p.m. the committee returned to the regular order of business to complete its discussion of the goals and related matters.

Ms. Van der Kloot addressed District Priority Goal number 7-1 and asked if a 10% increase in the use of IPASS/IParent was enough of a target. Concerns were raised that getting parents on to IParent was too slow and that more teachers should be using the system. After discussion the Superintendent agreed to look into the matter and report back. The goal would be reviewed as the year progressed.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry and seconded by Mr. Scarpelli the meeting was adjourned at 9:15 p.m.

Respectfully submitted,

John Falco
Chairperson